



The User Story Evaluation Matrix

Score every competitor against the stories your user actually has.

60 minutes

Research • Competitive • Product

A3 landscape

v1 • 2026

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— WHAT IT IS

What this canvas does

A competitive analysis that starts from the user rather than the feature list. Down the side go the user stories you learned from research — “as a [who], I need to [what] so that [why]”.

— WHEN TO USE IT

- Before committing a roadmap, to check you are building where the gap is.
- When a competitive slide is needed for investors or a board and the usual feature checklist feels dishonest.
- After an empathy canvas or interview round, to turn stories into priorities.

— BOX BY BOX

The short version

01 • THE ROWS – USER STORIES

Write eight to twelve stories from research, in the form: as a [who], I need to [what], so that [why]. Order them by how often they came up.

03 • THE SCORES

Score every cell 0–3 with evidence: a demo, a review, a customer interview. Colour the cells.

05 • YOUR COLUMN

Add yourself as the last column and score honestly, today — not the roadmap.

— WHO IT IS FOR

Product managers and founders deciding what to build first, and anyone writing a competitive slide that needs to be true. 60 minutes with three to eight people.

02 • THE COLUMNS – COMPETITORS

List the real alternatives your user has today: direct competitors, indirect ones, the spreadsheet, and doing nothing.

04 • READING THE GRID

Find the columns of 3s (table stakes), the rows of 0s (nobody serves this) and the rows where scores disagree (contested).

The Canvas Pack (£49) has the full walkthrough for every canvas — what good looks like for each box, a worked example, the agenda and the mistakes — plus clean A3 PDFs and 4K PNGs.
frameworks.dianasimpsonhernandez.com/canvas/